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Customer Experience Analysis Report

Online Matrimony Applications in India

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Analysis Scope



Understanding customer challenges, complaints, frauds, and opportunities in the Indian matrimony industry.

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Turning Customer Insights into ***Business Opportunities***

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Executive Summary

The Indian matrimony sector has undergone considerable transformation with the increasing use of digital matchmaking platforms. Apps such as Shaadi.com, BharatMatrimony, Jeevansathi and BetterHalf have created convenient ways for individuals to connect with potential life partners. Despite this digital growth, customer reviews indicate that users continue to face several challenges while using these services.

This study examines 15,000 Google Play Store reviews of four major matrimony applications, covering the period from September 2018 to October 2026. The research focuses on evaluating user experiences, understanding satisfaction levels, identifying recurring complaints and comparing the performance of different platforms.

The findings reveal an overall average rating of 1.95 out of 5, highlighting considerable dissatisfaction among users. Nearly 75% of the collected reviews reflect negative experiences. Some of the most commonly discussed issues relate to suspicious or misleading profiles, potential scams, costly subscription plans, refund-related difficulties, limited communication options and technical problems within the applications.

To gain a deeper understanding of these issues, the study also applies statistical techniques to compare scam-related complaints and customer support response times across the selected platforms. The results suggest differences in user experiences between applications. Furthermore, correlation analysis identifies an association between review length and ratings, indicating that longer reviews tend to be linked with lower customer ratings.

The research highlights several improvement opportunities for matrimony platforms. These include strengthening identity and profile verification procedures, making subscription policies and payment terms clearer, improving application performance, providing better communication facilities and developing more responsive customer support systems.

In conclusion, this study uses customer feedback and statistical evidence to highlight the major service-related challenges within the Indian online matrimony industry. The findings offer useful insights into customer expectations and areas requiring attention, which can support the development of more trustworthy, transparent and user-oriented matchmaking services.

Key findings at a glance

Measure	Result
Reviews analysed	15,000 Google Play Store reviews (September 2018 – October 2026)
Applications covered	Shaadi.com, BharatMatrimony, Jeevansathi, BetterHalf
Overall average rating	1.95 out of 5
Sentiment split	74.5% negative, 21.1% positive, 4.4% neutral
Reviews raising pricing / value-for-money concerns	About 38%
Reviews with potential scam-related flags	3,734 (24.89%)
Support reply rate / median reply time	96% / about 22 hours

Project Introduction

The growing use of digital technology has brought significant changes to the way people search for life partners. Online matrimony applications have become a popular alternative to conventional matchmaking methods, allowing individuals to explore potential matches according to their personal preferences. These platforms offer various services, including profile registration, advanced search options, direct communication and paid membership plans.

In the Indian market, platforms such as Shaadi.com, BharatMatrimony, Jeevansathi and BetterHalf provide digital matchmaking services to a wide range of users. Although these applications share a common purpose, they differ in terms of available features, subscription costs, service quality and overall user experience.

Despite the convenience offered by these platforms, customer feedback highlights several concerns that affect user satisfaction. Complaints about fake or inactive profiles, expensive membership plans, payment and refund issues, restricted messaging features and application performance suggest that there is a gap between customer expectations and the services delivered.

To examine these concerns, this project analyses a dataset of 15,000 customer reviews collected from the Google Play Store. The study uses Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA), review classification and statistical methods to investigate customer ratings, recognise frequently reported problems and evaluate differences in user experiences across the four selected applications.

Rather than focusing only on numerical ratings, the research explores the underlying factors contributing to customer dissatisfaction. By identifying recurring service gaps and customer concerns, the study aims to provide meaningful insights that can support business decisions, improve service quality and contribute to a more reliable and customer-friendly online matrimony experience.

Project Objectives

The primary aim of this project is to evaluate customer experiences with major online matrimony applications, understand the challenges faced by users and identify potential areas for service improvement. The study is guided by the following specific objectives:

1. **Assess Customer Satisfaction:** Evaluate user ratings and review sentiments to determine the overall level of satisfaction with the four selected matrimony applications.
2. **Recognise Common User Complaints:** Explore customer feedback to identify recurring problems involving suspicious profiles, fraudulent activities, membership charges, refunds, technical issues and communication facilities.
3. **Conduct Platform-Wise Comparison:** Compare Shaadi.com, BharatMatrimony, Jeevansathi and BetterHalf by examining their customer ratings, reported problems and service experiences.
4. **Investigate Trust and Security Issues:** Examine feedback concerning profile authenticity, fake accounts and possible fraudulent activities to understand the role of trust and safety in online matchmaking.
5. **Analyse Membership and Payment-Related Issues:** Assess user experiences with paid subscriptions, payment procedures, automatic renewals, membership cancellations and refund processes.
6. **Assess Customer Support Services:** Compare customer support response times across the selected platforms and identify possible gaps in complaint handling and problem resolution.
7. **Perform Statistical Analysis:** Apply appropriate statistical methods, including Chi-Square testing, One-Way ANOVA and correlation analysis, to examine significant patterns, differences and relationships in customer feedback.
8. **Develop Practical Business Recommendations:** Translate the research outcomes into actionable suggestions that can help matrimony platforms address user concerns and enhance service quality.
9. **Generate Insights for Business Planning:** Use evidence from customer reviews to identify improvement opportunities and support the development of customer-oriented strategies for existing and emerging matrimony businesses.

Matrimony Industry Overview

Marriage and partner selection have traditionally been influenced by family relationships, relatives, community connections and local matchmaking services in India. Over time, increased internet accessibility and smartphone adoption have changed this traditional approach, making digital matchmaking an increasingly common option.

Online matrimony applications allow individuals to create profiles, mention their partner preferences and explore potential matches across different locations. Most platforms operate through a combination of free registration and paid subscription models. Premium memberships generally provide additional facilities, such as access to contact information, messaging options and other advanced services.

Platforms covered in this study

- **Shaadi.com:** A recognised matchmaking platform that provides profile discovery, partner preference settings and premium membership options.
- **BharatMatrimony:** A digital service that helps users find potential partners based on regional, cultural and community preferences.
- **Jeevansathi:** An online matchmaking platform that offers profile-based searches and subscription-based communication features.
- **BetterHalf:** A technology-driven matchmaking application that focuses on personalized recommendations and digital partner discovery.

Customer-related challenges

Despite making partner searches more accessible, these applications continue to face customer-related challenges. Reviews frequently highlight concerns about profile authenticity, inactive accounts, high subscription costs, refund complications, communication restrictions and technical performance.

An analysis of 15,000 customer reviews reveals an average rating of 1.95 out of 5 across the selected applications. Approximately 75% of the reviews reflect negative customer experiences. Pricing-related concerns are identified in nearly 38% of reviews, while around 25% contain potential scam-related concerns.

These results indicate that improving the matchmaking process alone may not be sufficient to ensure customer satisfaction. Greater attention is also required towards genuine profile verification, transparent subscription policies, reliable application performance and effective customer support. Addressing these areas could help matrimony platforms build greater user confidence and deliver a better overall experience.

Data and Methodology

Dataset

- **Source:** Customer reviews from the Google Play Store.
- **Size and period:** 15,000 reviews, covering September 2018 to October 2026.
- **Applications:** Shaadi.com, BharatMatrimony, Jeevansathi and BetterHalf.

Analytical approach

- **Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)** of ratings, sentiment, review length, engagement (thumbs-up) and support replies.
- **Review classification** using two lenses: (a) text-based keyword rules, where one review can fall into several categories (used for the 13 pain points and the complaint categories), and (b) the dataset's own flag columns (is_scam, is_billing, is_call_harassment, is_contact_issue, is_tech_issue), which are broader than the text rules.
- **Customer segmentation:** each review is placed in one segment – satisfied advocates first, otherwise the most severe grievance (scam/fraud, then billing and refunds, then call harassment and privacy, then match quality, then paywall, then technical issues).
- **Statistical testing:** Chi-Square test, One-Way ANOVA and correlation analysis.

Reading the results

- Promoters are 4–5★ reviews and detractors are 1–2★ reviews. The resulting score is a review-based proxy, not a survey NPS.
- Scam-related flags do not confirm that fraud actually occurred; they indicate that a review contains potentially scam-related language.
- Support reply timing excludes 631 replies that were dated before the review they answer (probably edited reviews).
- Counts are not rates, and 2026 data may be incomplete, so year-on-year movements should be read with care.

Customer Sentiment and Satisfaction

Overall rating baseline

Across the 15,000-review dataset the average rating is 1.95 out of 5 and **74.5% of reviews are negative** (21.1% positive, 4.4% neutral). Ratings pile up at the extremes: about 68% of all reviews are 1★, with a smaller peak at 5★.

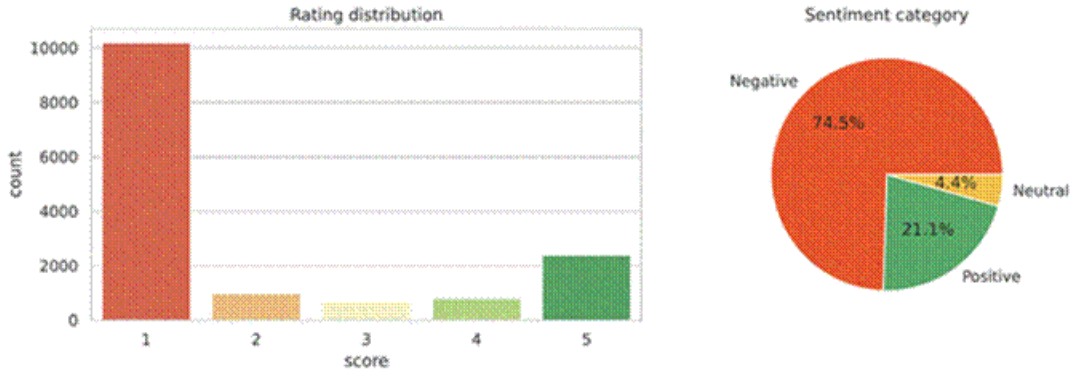


Figure 1 – Ratings pile up at 1★ (68%) and 5★; sentiment is three-quarters negative.

Platform-wise comparison

The three legacy platforms – BharatMatrimony, Jeevansathi and Shaadi.com – cluster between roughly 1.74★ and 1.81★. Only the newer entrant, BetterHalf, holds a noticeably higher rating (about 3.08★), although it faces its own technical hurdles.

App	Avg rating	Satisfaction signal (promoters − detractors)
BetterHalf	3.08★	about +5 points
Shaadi	1.81★	about −61 points
BharatMatrimony	1.76★	about −63 points
Jeevansathi	1.74★	about −64 points

Shaadi, BharatMatrimony and Jeevansathi receive nearly the same rating and the same complaints, so the market leaders are not differentiated in the eyes of unhappy users. A competitor that fixes trust and billing could stand out quickly.

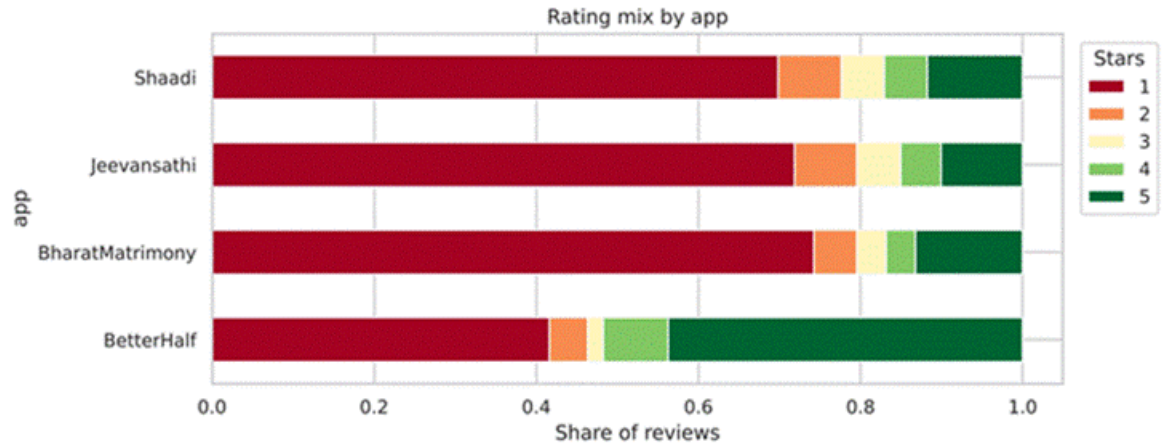


Figure 2 – Rating mix by app: BetterHalf has far more 4–5★ reviews than the three older apps.

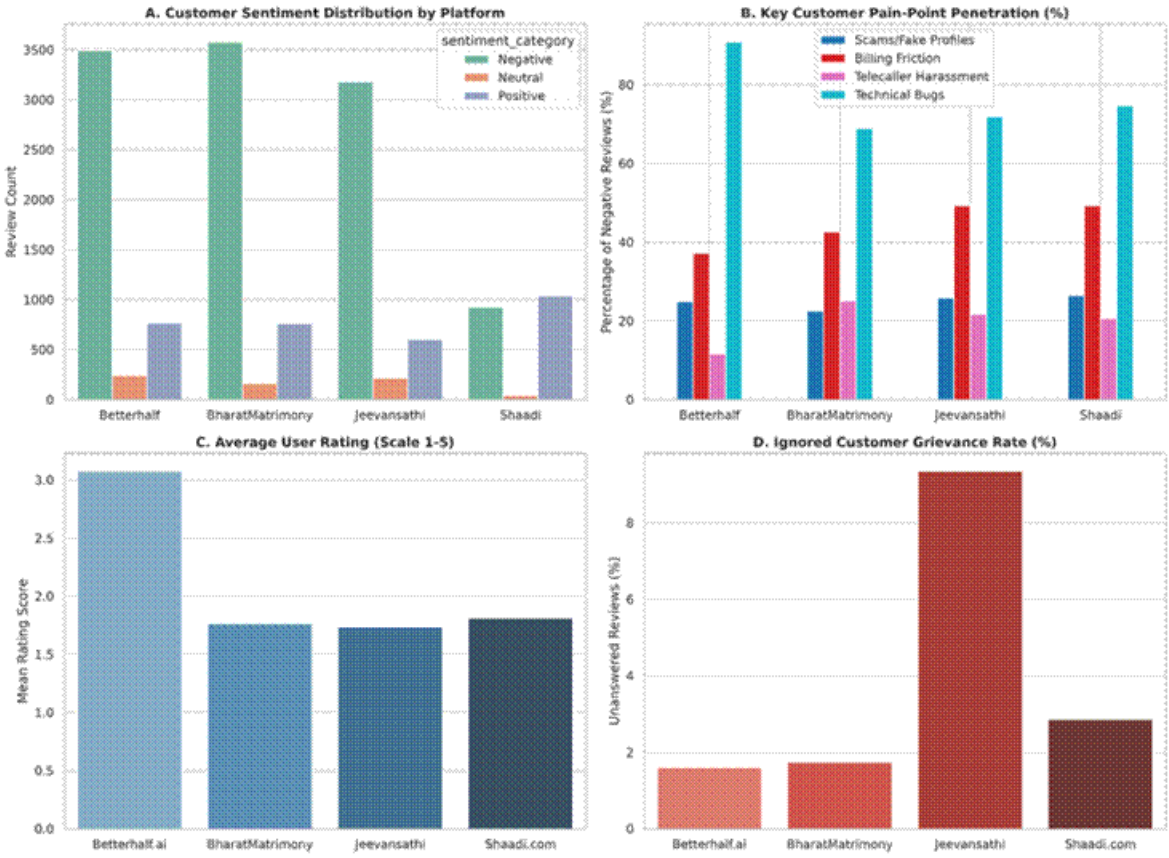


Figure 3 – Platform comparison: (A) sentiment by platform, (B) key pain-point penetration among negative reviews, (C) average user rating, (D) ignored customer grievance rate.

What drives praise and complaints

Happy customers praise ease of use and good matches; unhappy customers talk about money and trust. Among 4–5★ reviews the most common themes are an easy, clean app and finding a good or genuine match. Among 1–2★ reviews the dominant words are *waste of money*, *paid membership* and *customer care*. The product concept is liked; the commercial experience around it is not.

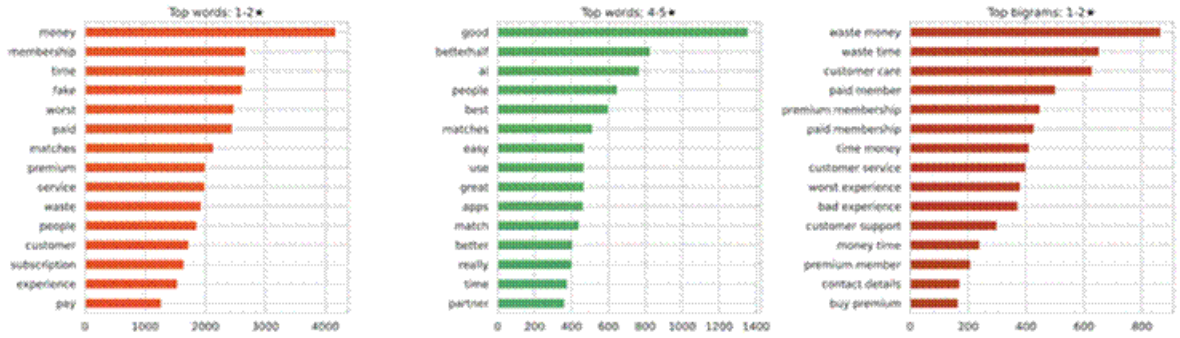


Figure 4 – Most frequent words and phrases in 1–2★ versus 4–5★ reviews.

Sentiment over time

Sentiment worsened over time, then partially recovered. The yearly average peaked in 2020 (2.43★), bottomed in 2025 (1.37★) and rose to about 2.04★ in 2026. It should be checked whether the 2026 rebound reflects genuine improvement or simply a larger share of BetterHalf reviews in the latest data before it is read as a turnaround.

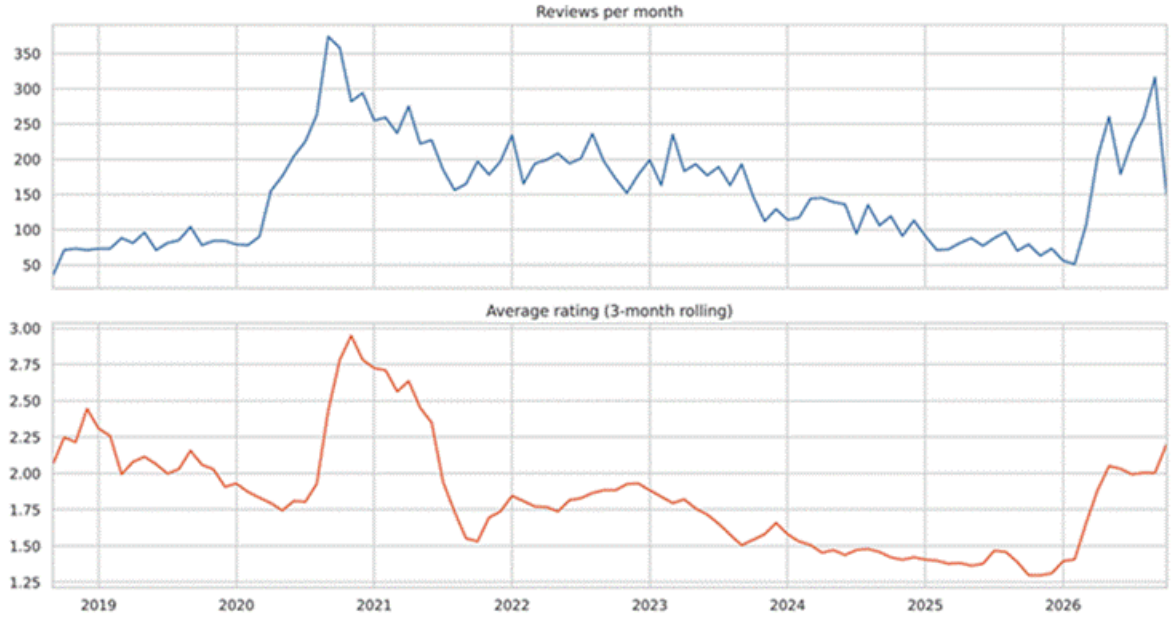


Figure 5 – Review volume per month and the 3-month rolling average rating.



Figure 6 – Average rating by app, 6-month rolling: the older apps drift down together while BetterHalf stays higher.

Customer Segmentation and Behaviour

Reviewer segments

Each review was placed in one segment: satisfied advocates first, otherwise the most severe grievance (scam/fraud, then billing and refunds, then call harassment and privacy, then match quality, then paywall, then technical issues).

- **Satisfied advocates (21% of reviews)** average 4.76★. They are the only group with a healthy relationship with the product.
- **Scam / fraud-alarmed users (about 25%) are the single largest segment**, ahead of satisfied advocates. This is the most important structural finding: more reviewers feel deceived than feel happy.
- **Billing and refund-aggrieved users** and **tech-frustrated users** form the next tier.
- **Match-quality seekers, call-harassment victims and paywall-blocked users** are smaller but equally unhappy (about 1.2–1.5★).

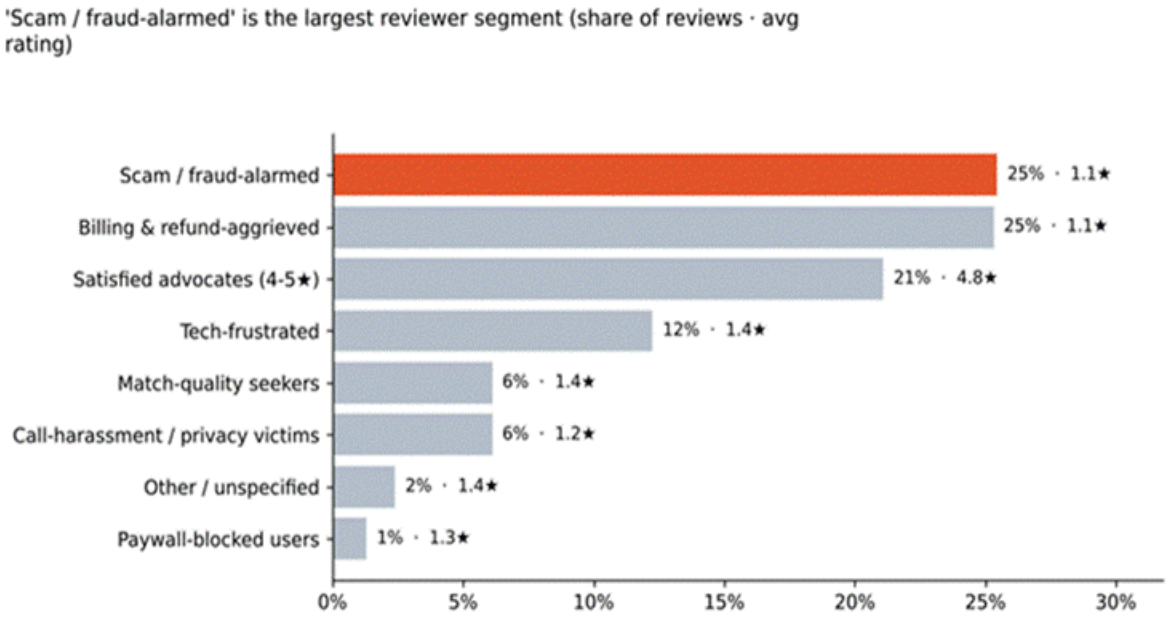


Figure 7 – Reviewer segments by share of reviews and average rating.

Behavioural patterns

- **Reviews with more thumbs-up are more negative.** Reviews with no engagement average 2.25★; those with 6–50 thumbs-up average 1.68★. Negative reviews are the ones other users find useful, so they shape the public perception of each app.
- **Longer reviews are angrier.** Reviews over 450 characters average 1.46★ versus 2.32★ for reviews under 150 characters. Detailed stories of being treated badly are common (see the correlation test in Section 11).
- **Named reviewers are far happier than anonymous ones** (3.08★ versus 1.77★), though only 13% of reviews are named. Anonymity is the norm for complaints.

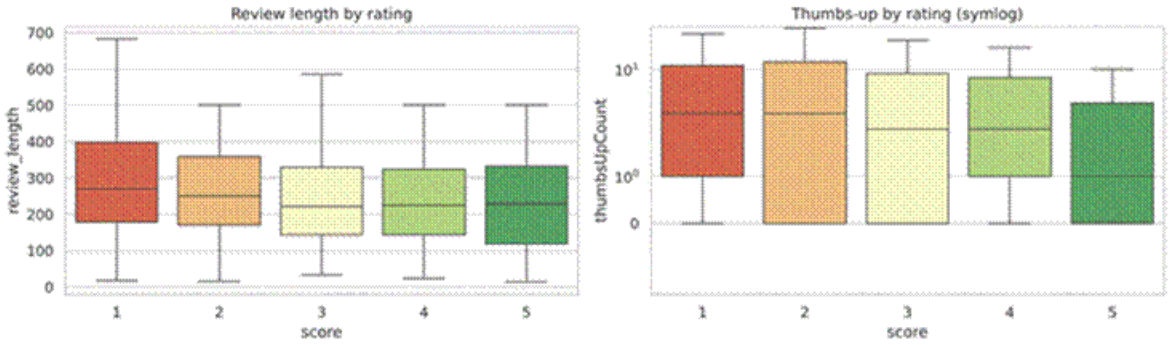


Figure 8 – Longer reviews and more heavily upvoted reviews skew to low ratings.

Trust, Fake Profile and Scam Analysis

Overview of the trust deficit

Trust is the most sensitive issue in this market. Between **22.5% and 26.4%** of reviews on each platform are flagged for accusations of fake profiles, bots and financial scams, with Shaadi highest at 26.4%. Reviewers describe a typical narrative: a user sees many interest requests before paying, pays for premium, then finds the profiles inactive, mismatched or unresponsive, and cannot get a refund.

Complaint categories (text-based rules)

Complaints were categorised with keyword rules. The table ranks categories by severity, which combines how common a complaint is among unhappy reviews with how low the rating is when it appears.

Category	Share of all reviews	Avg rating when mentioned
Fake / bot profiles	15.5%	1.36★
Scam / fraud / cheating claims	11.6%	1.27★
Refund refused / disputes	3.9%	1.05★
Verification / authenticity gap	5.8%	1.73★
Spam / sales-call pressure	3.5%	1.26★
Paid but no genuine responses	2.8%	1.10★
Unauthorised charges / auto-renewal	1.8%	1.16★
Romance / money-asking scammers	1.9%	1.82★
Privacy / data misuse	1.5%	1.88★

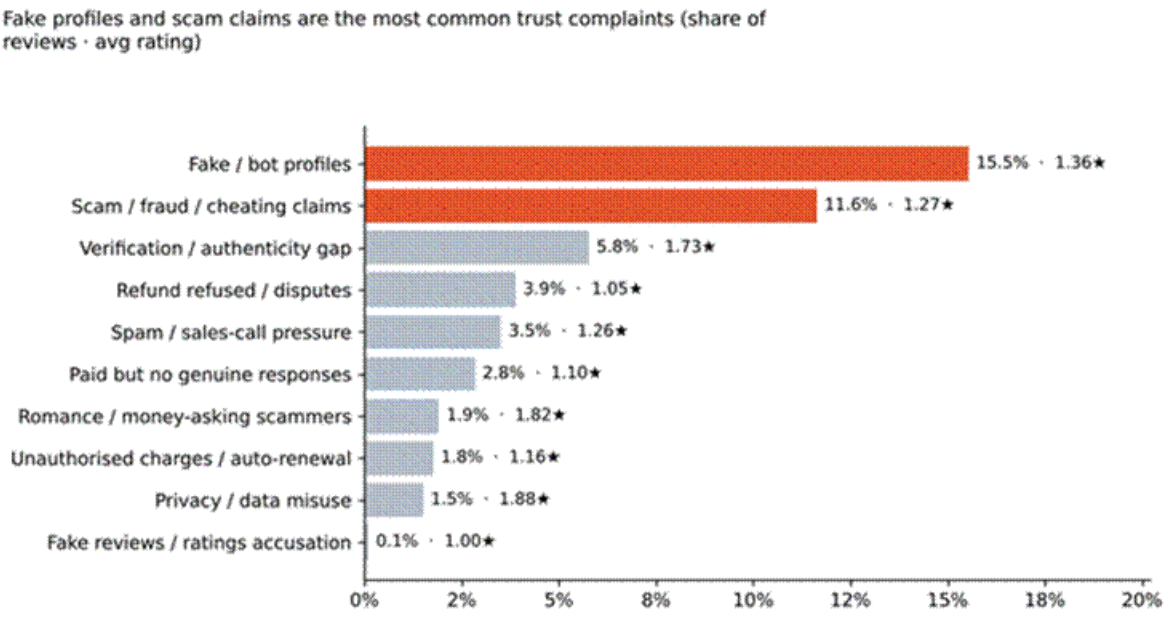


Figure 9 – Complaint categories by share of all reviews, with average rating when mentioned.

Interpretation

- **"Scam" means two different things.** One is *fake or inactive profiles* (the user cannot find real people). The other is *commercial deception* (paying and then receiving nothing, being refused a refund, being pressured by sales calls). Reviews describing the second type give the lowest ratings (1.05–1.10★), so fixing billing and refund transparency is high impact.
- **Trust issues are not unique to the weak apps.** Between 28% and 36% of reviews on every app raise one, including BetterHalf (31%). The difference is tolerance: BetterHalf reviewers who raise a trust issue still give about 1.97★, versus roughly 1.1–1.2★ on the other apps.

Trend over time

The problem has been growing. Fake-profile mentions rose from 12% of reviews in 2020 to 22% in 2025, and scam or fraud claims from 8% to 19%. The 2026 figures are lower (15% and 13%), but the caveat about the mix of recent data (Section 6.4) applies.

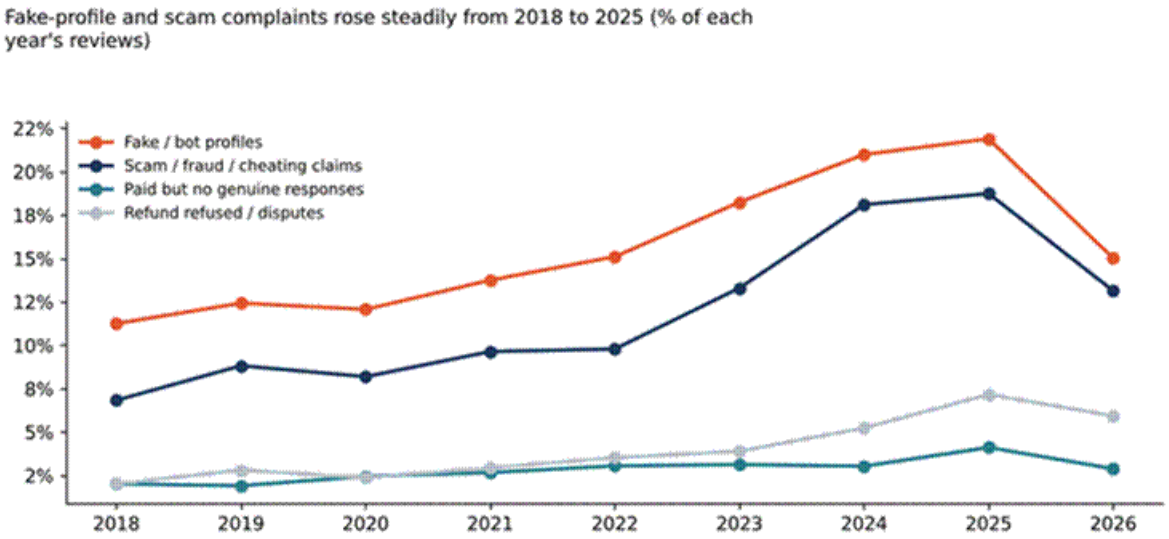


Figure 10 – Fake-profile, scam, paid-no-response and refund complaints as a share of each year's reviews.

Overall scam-flag distribution

The dataset identified **3,734 reviews (24.89%)** with potential scam-related content; the remaining 11,266 reviews (75.11%) were not flagged.

Business interpretation: User trust and profile safety deserve attention, and platforms could review their profile verification and complaint-handling processes. These flags do not confirm that fraud actually occurred.

Flagged reviews by application

Application	Flagged review count	Interpretation
Shaadi	1,190	Highest raw count in this dataset; suitable for further investigation.
Jeevansathi	1,033	Second-highest raw count.
BharatMatrimony	1,013	Close to Jeevansathi in raw count.
BetterHalf	498	Lowest raw count among the four applications.

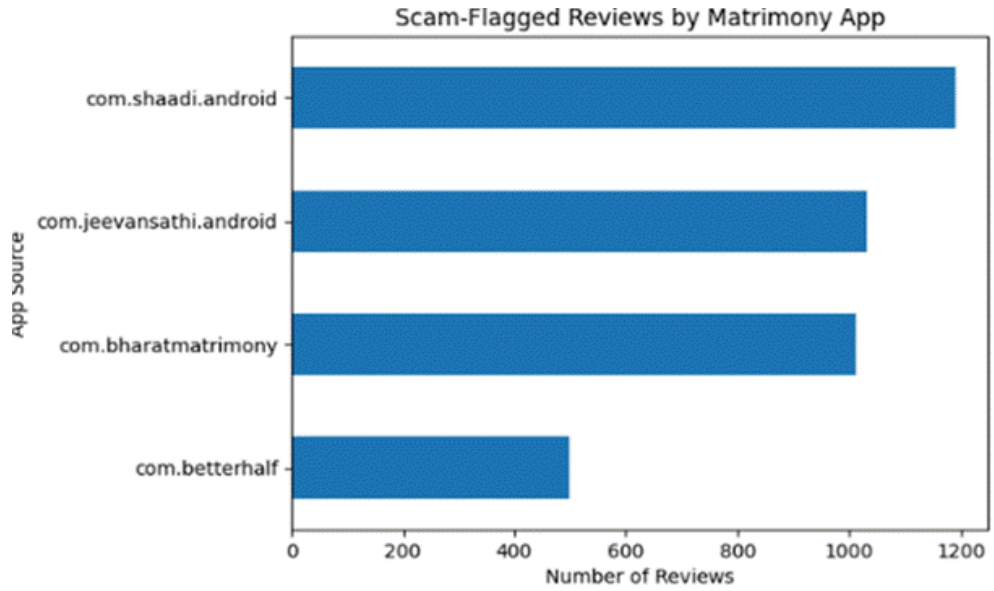


Figure 11 – Scam-flagged reviews by matrimony app.

Business interpretation: Potential scam-related concerns appeared across all four applications. Each platform may benefit from reviewing its user-verification and safety measures.

Scam-related keywords and categories

The analysis searched for words such as fake profile, fraud, scam, money, blackmail and impersonation. These keywords help identify the types of concerns mentioned in customer reviews.

Scam keyword	Frequency	What it may indicate
money	1,795	Payment-related concerns
fraud	612	Money and fraud references
scam	591	Money and fraud references
fake profile	257	Profile authenticity concerns
cheating	112	Deception concerns
fake account	32	Profile authenticity concerns
blackmail	5	User-safety issues
harassment	3	User-safety issues

impersonation	0	Need for stronger identity checks
duplicate profile	0	Profile authenticity concerns

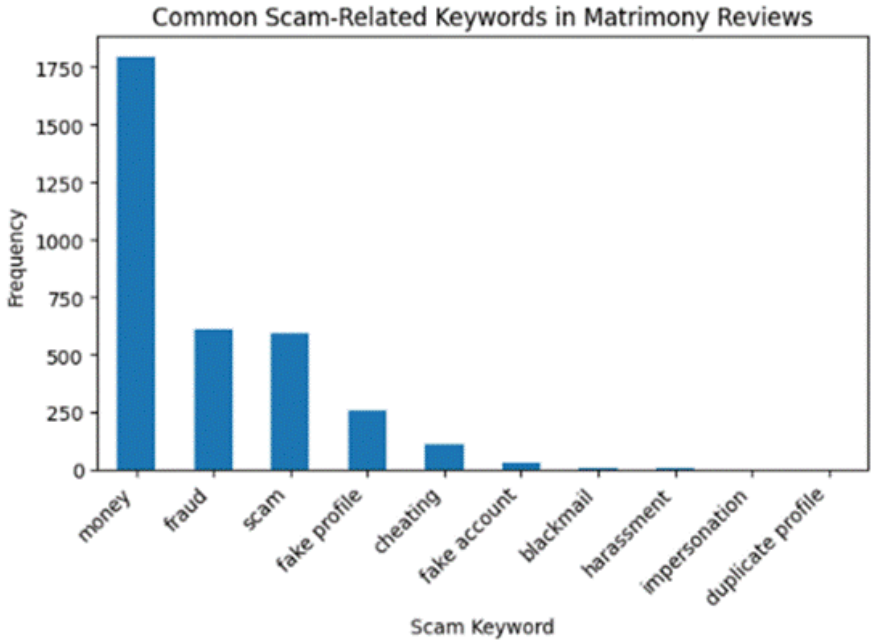


Figure 12 – Common scam-related keywords in matrimony reviews.

Rule-based category	Reviews	Share of flagged reviews
Financial Scams	1,383	37.04%
Other / Needs Review	1,229	32.91%
Fake Profiles	1,119	29.97%
Blackmail / Threats	3	Approximately 0.08%

Financial Scams was the largest category, with 1,383 reviews. Fake Profiles accounted for 1,119 reviews, while 1,229 reviews were placed under Other / Needs Review.

Business interpretation: Financial safety and profile verification are important areas to investigate. The large Other / Needs Review category also shows that the current classification needs improvement.

Yearly and monthly pattern of flagged reviews

Flagged reviews reached their highest yearly count in 2023, with 581 reviews. The count was 326 in 2025 and increased to 459 in 2026. By month, September had the highest count (396), followed by August (367); January had the lowest (261).

Year	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
Flagged reviews	45	206	523	557	543	581	494	326	459

Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Flagged reviews	261	262	293	312	357	296	316	367	396	334	265	275

Business interpretation: Scam-related feedback appears in different years and months. However, these figures show counts rather than rates, and the 2026 data may be incomplete. More detailed analysis is needed before identifying any seasonal pattern.

Customer Pain-Point Analysis

Key pain points (text-based rules)

Thirteen pain points were detected in the reviews. The most important are:

1. **Pricing and value for money** – mentioned in 38% of all reviews and 46% of 1–2★ reviews; rating when mentioned about 1.32★. This is the largest and most damaging pain point on every app.
2. **Fake / low-quality profiles** – 17% of reviews; rises steadily from 11% in 2018 to 25% in 2025.
3. **Customer support experience** – 11% of reviews, about 1.36★; grew from 7% (2018) to 16% (2025).
4. **App bugs and login / OTP problems** – 12% and 9% of reviews. Bug complaints are most common for BharatMatrimony (about 19% of its unhappy reviews).
5. **Paywall on messaging and contact** – 9% of reviews, highest for BetterHalf and Shaadi among unhappy reviewers.
6. **Refund and cancellation** – only 5% of reviews but the lowest rating (about 1.16★): a small group that is extremely angry.
7. **Search and filter limits** – frequent (18%) but less damaging (about 2.05★); users keep using the app while grumbling.

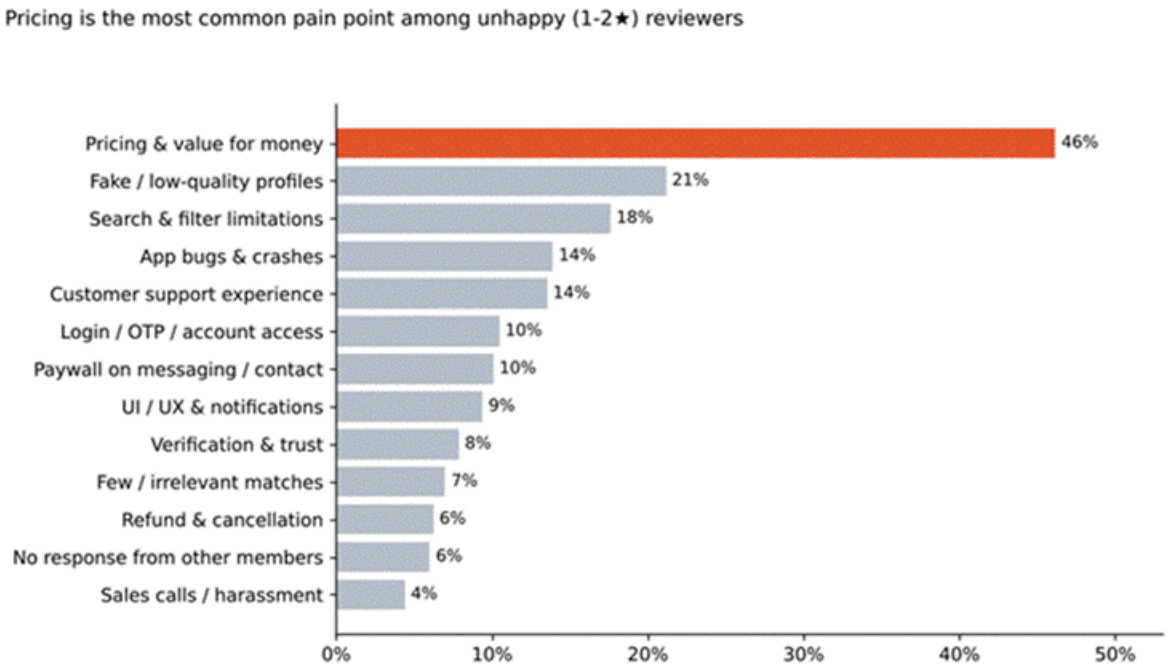


Figure 13 – Share of 1–2★ reviews mentioning each pain point.

Pain points by application

- Pain points cluster: pricing and fake-profile complaints appear together in more than a tenth of unhappy reviews, which supports the "I paid for something that was not real" narrative.
- The pain profile differs by app. Bugs hit BharatMatrimony harder, match relevance hurts Jeevansathi, and paywall and UI complaints are relatively higher for BetterHalf.

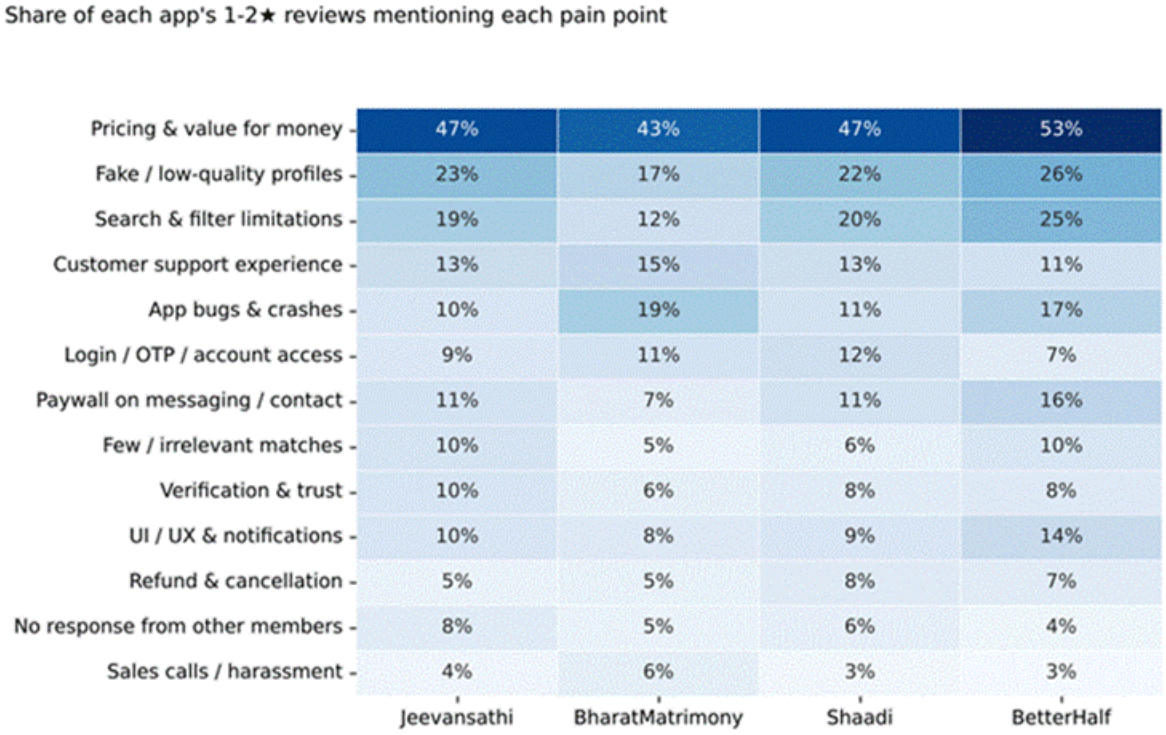


Figure 14 – Pain points by app, as a share of each app's 1–2★ reviews.

Broad complaint flags (dataset columns)

Pain point	Complaint flags	Interpretation
Technical Issues	11,150	Largest broad category; application reliability and performance merit attention.
Billing Issues	6,853	Payment, charges and billing processes are a major service concern.

Contact Issues	3,533	Communication and contact accessibility may need improvement.
Call Harassment	3,155	User protection and controls for unwanted calls require attention.

Technical Issues had the highest number of complaint flags (11,150), followed by Billing Issues (6,853), Contact Issues (3,533) and Call Harassment (3,155). A single review can carry several flags.

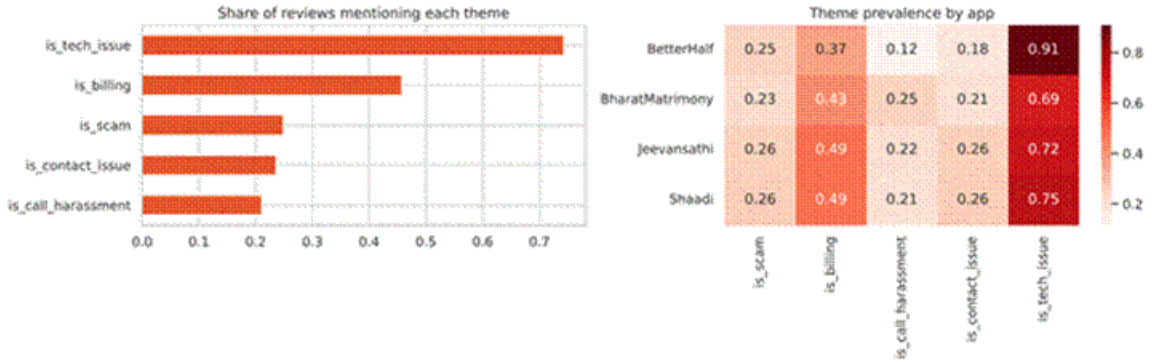


Figure 15 – Theme prevalence using the dataset's own flag columns (broader than the text rules used elsewhere).

Platform-level patterns

- **Billing friction** is the single largest financial complaint in the industry, affecting **49.3% of reviews on Shaadi and Jeevansathi** and **42.6% on BharatMatrimony**. Users object to rigid upfront paywalls, non-refundable annual lock-ins and surprise auto-debits.
- **Sales pressure and telecaller harassment** hit the legacy apps hardest – BharatMatrimony (25.0%) and Jeevansathi (21.7%) – because of aggressive telecaller sales teams calling users repeatedly.
- **Technical problems** are most severe for BetterHalf, where about 90.8% of reviews carry a technical-bug flag, attributed to rapid app iteration.

Business interpretation: Customers are raising concerns about more than just matching services. App performance, payments, communication and user safety also affect their experience.

Detailed text-based pain points

Detailed pain point	Review count	Interpretation
Other Issues	8,519 (56.79%)	Largest group; current keyword rules do not capture many reviews in specific categories.
Subscription Problems	3,620	Most prominent specifically identified category; review membership terms, pricing and refunds.
Messaging Problems	1,854	Communication functionality is a notable area for improvement.
Profile Issues	1,033	Profile authenticity and inactive or misleading profiles deserve attention.
App Performance	535	Application speed and stability concerns.
Login & Access	369	Difficulty signing in or accessing accounts.
Account Restrictions	240	Accounts blocked or limited.
UI/UX Problems	124	Navigation and interface concerns.

Subscription Problems had the highest count among the specifically identified pain points (3,620 reviews), followed by Messaging Problems (1,854) and Profile Issues (1,033). Categories can overlap, so counts should not be added together. Other Issues was the largest group (8,519 reviews, 56.79%).

Business interpretation: Subscription services, messaging and profile quality are important areas for improvement. The large Other Issues group suggests that the current keyword rules do not capture many complaints clearly.

Review sample inspection

The 20 Shaadi reviews examined included complaints about app performance, subscription charges, login problems, fake profiles, account restrictions and messaging. This shows that one customer review can mention several different problems. Reading sample reviews helps us understand issues that keyword-based analysis may not fully capture.

Customer Support Response Analysis

Reply rate and speed

- Reply rate is high (96%), with a median of about 22 hours; about 55% of replies arrive within a day.
- Replies to 4–5★ reviews are less common (91–93%) than to 1–3★ reviews (97%), so the team is clearly prioritising unhappy customers.
- 631 replies were dated before the review they answer (probably edited reviews); these were excluded from timing statistics.

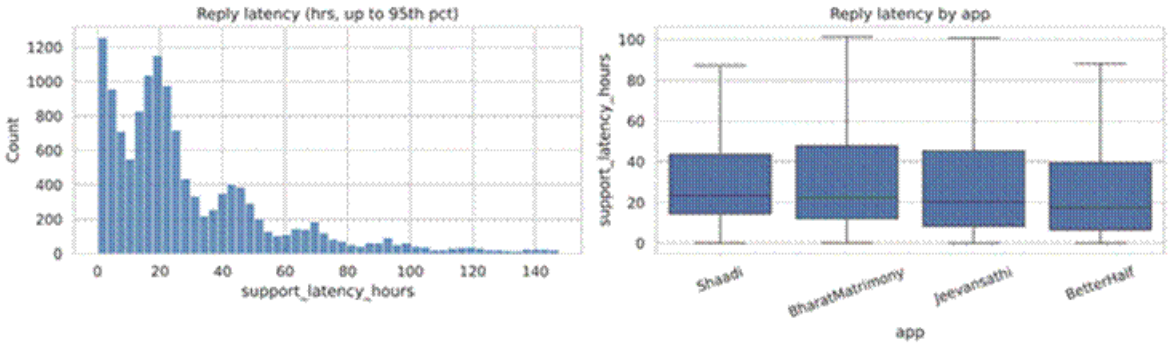


Figure 16 – Reply latency distribution and by app (hours; replies dated before the review excluded).

Resolution gap

- **Resolution is not visible.** 79% of replies point the user to an e-mail address or ask them to write in. Public replies therefore work as deflection, and the reviews show customers repeating the same complaint despite the replies.
- Legacy platforms struggle with response bottlenecks, and many complaints go unanswered. The differences between platforms in response times are statistically significant (Section 11, Test 2).
- Customer support is also a rising pain point in its own right: mentioned in 11% of reviews, up from 7% in 2018 to 16% in 2025 (Section 9.1).

Statistical Analysis

Three statistical tests were applied to examine whether the patterns seen in the reviews are likely to be due to chance. The table summarises the results; each test is explained below.

Test	Question examined	Result	Conclusion
Chi-Square	Do scam allegation rates differ across platforms?	$\chi^2 = 21.31$, $p = 0.00009$ ($p < 0.0001$)	Scam rates differ significantly by platform
One-Way ANOVA	Do support response times differ across platforms?	$F = 411.01$, $p = 1.03 \times 10^{-255}$	Extremely significant differences
Correlation	Is review length related to star rating?	$r = -0.155$	Weak negative correlation

Test 1: Scam allegation variance (Chi-Square)

Result: $\chi^2 = 21.31$, $p = 0.00009$ ($p < 0.0001$).

Interpretation: A Chi-Square test checked whether scam and fake-profile complaints occur by random chance or vary significantly across different apps. The test shows conclusively ($p < 0.0001$) that scam rates are tied to specific platforms, with legacy apps such as Shaadi and Jeevansathi showing scam allegation rates of up to about 26%.

Test 2: Customer support response variance (One-Way ANOVA)

Result: $F = 411.01$, $p = 1.03 \times 10^{-255}$ (extremely significant).

Interpretation: An ANOVA variance test compared customer service response times across platforms. The results show massive, statistically significant differences in how competitors handle user grievances, with average response latencies fluctuating widely and thousands of complaints being completely ignored.

Test 3: Grievance intensity and review length (Correlation)

Result: correlation coefficient $r = -0.155$ (negative correlation).

Interpretation: There is a negative correlation between review length and star rating. Users leaving 5★ reviews write short, quick praise, whereas users leaving 1★ reviews write significantly longer, highly detailed paragraphs describing financial loss and fraud.

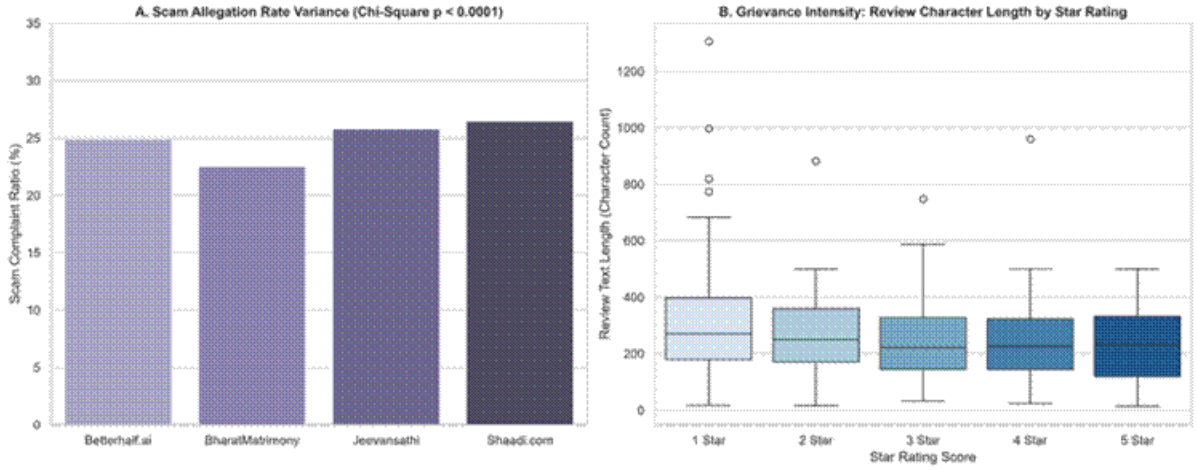


Figure 17 – (A) Scam complaint ratio by platform (Chi-Square, p < 0.0001); (B) review length by star rating.

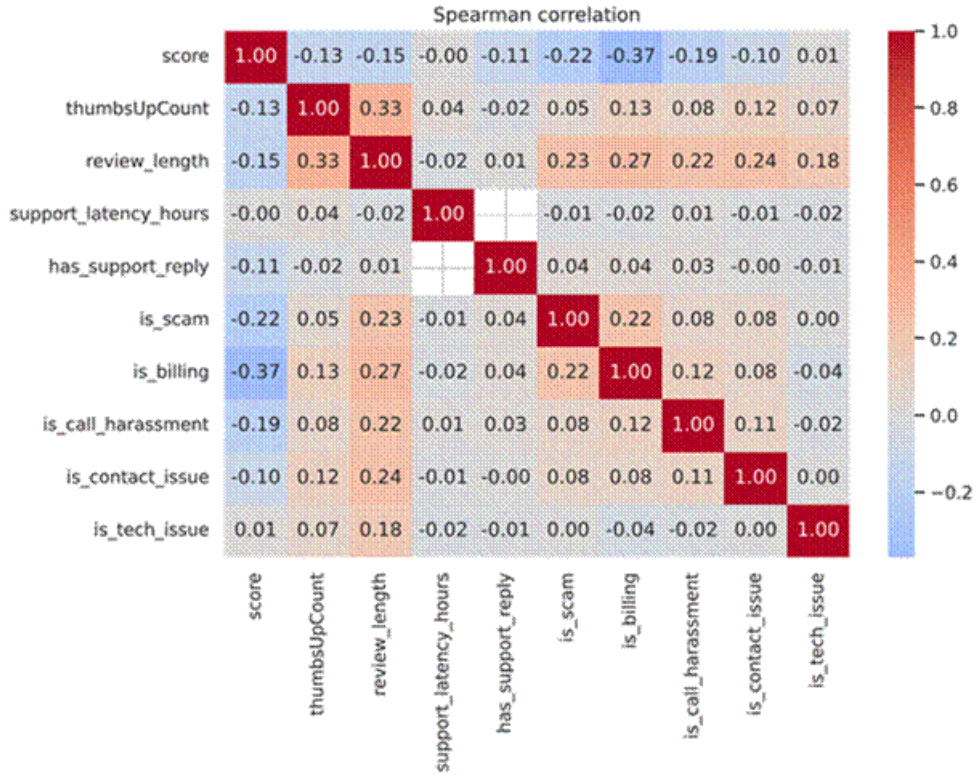


Figure 18 – Spearman correlation between rating, engagement, support variables and the dataset flags.

Industry Challenges

The review evidence points to seven structural challenges facing online matrimony platforms:

1. **Trust deficit** – fake profiles, inactive members and bait-and-switch experiences. Matrimony is a high-stakes, trust-based purchase, so perceived fraud destroys word of mouth.
2. **Monetisation friction** – subscriptions are sold before outcomes are proven; refunds and cancellations are hard.
3. **Paywalled core interaction** – users cannot judge quality before paying.
4. **Sales-led conversion** – call pressure and privacy worries create brand and regulatory risk.
5. **Support that replies but does not resolve** – deflection erodes ratings.
6. **Declining reputation across incumbents** – ratings fell sharply after 2020.
7. **Match relevance** – India-specific needs (region, community, family preferences) are poorly served by generic filters.

Market Opportunities

Ranked opportunities

Opportunities were scored by how many unhappy reviews they address and how low the rating is among those reviews. The full ranking and suggested actions are in sheet 6 of the supporting workbook.

- **Verified-profile guarantee** (ID, photo and liveness checks, visible trust badges, removal of inactive profiles). Ranks first and addresses about 23% of unhappy reviews.
- **Outcome-aligned pricing:** pay-after-results, time-boxed premium trials, pro-rata refunds, money-back guarantees.
- **A meaningful free tier,** such as a small free chat quota, so users can test quality before paying.
- **Transparent subscriptions** with renewal reminders and one-tap cancellation.
- **Consent-based calling** and clear privacy controls.
- **Resolution-focused support** with ticketing and escalation for refunds and fraud.
- **Smarter matching and richer saved searches,** including region and community filters.
- **Reliable app performance,** especially login and OTP flows.

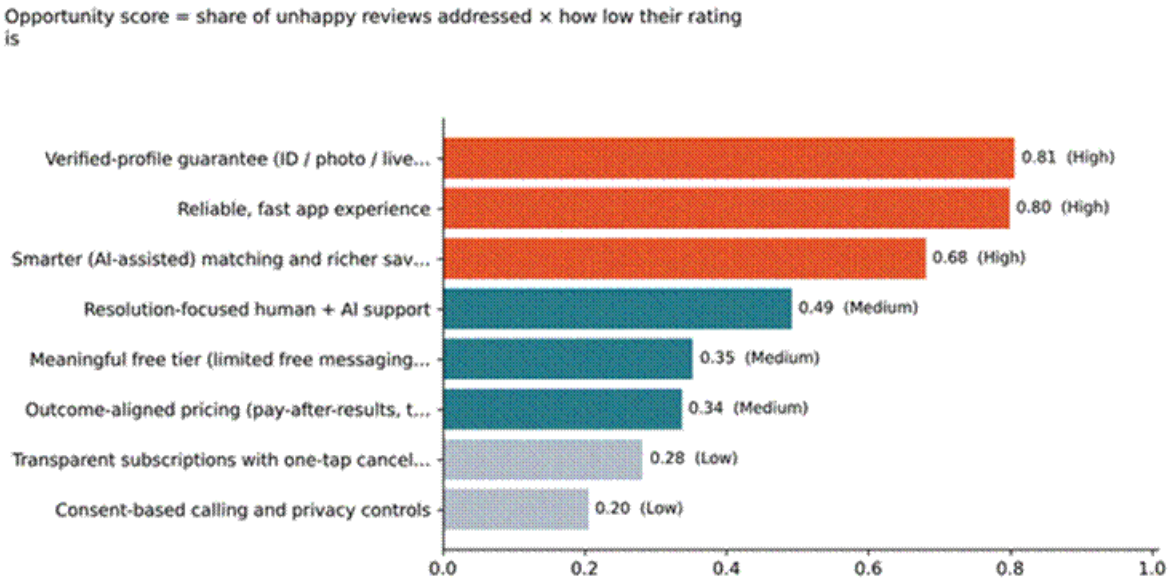


Figure 19 – Opportunity score: share of unhappy reviews addressed × how low their rating is.

From challenge to opportunity

Industry challenge identified	Potential market opportunity
Fake Profiles and Scams	AI-powered profile verification and fraud detection
Subscription and Payment Issues	Transparent subscription and payment systems
Messaging and Communication Problems	Reliable in-app messaging solutions
User Privacy and Data Security	Stronger privacy and data-protection features
Low Trust and Profile Verification	Verified-user badges and identity checks
Poor App Experience and Performance	Improved app performance and user-friendly design

Potential opportunity	Expected business value
AI-Powered Profile Verification	Increase user trust and reduce fake profiles
Smart Subscription Management	Improve payment transparency and customer satisfaction
Secure Messaging Platform	Protect users and improve communication
AI-Based Fraud Detection	Detect suspicious accounts and behaviour
Improved Customer Support	Resolve customer complaints faster
Better App Performance	Improve user experience and retention

These challenges suggest opportunities such as AI-powered profile verification, fraud detection, secure messaging, better subscription management and improved customer support.

Business interpretation: These ideas could help matrimony platforms improve their services and customer experience. Further research is needed to understand which solutions customers need most.

Business Recommendations

Based on the matrimony industry research and customer feedback analysis, the following recommendations are proposed for the new matrimony business (the client).

Strategic positioning from the data

The overwhelming negative sentiment shows that existing market leaders have alienated their user base. Customers are not just slightly unhappy – they are actively looking for a modern, reliable alternative, which gives a new entrant a wide-open runway to capture displaced, frustrated users. Four moves follow directly from the evidence:

1. **Monetise security with a Mandatory Video and Government ID (Aadhaar/PAN) KYC tier.** Users fear being scammed after paying hard-earned money, and the Chi-Square result shows that trust problems are an industry-wide structural failure rather than isolated incidents. Positioning safety as a core feature lets the client capture users fleeing unverified, scam-prone platforms, and users are likely to pay a premium for a verified environment.
2. **Fix the paywall with a value-first micro-transaction model** (for example pay-per-contact, chat token bundles or affordable day-passes). Forcing users into expensive annual packages before they experience the platform hurts conversion; lower entry barriers drive sign-ups and create predictable cash flow.
3. **Build a privacy-first brand with a "Zero Telecaller Spam" policy,** offering complete in-app self-management without intrusive sales pressure. Modern urban users dislike aggressive offline sales calls.
4. **Make support an operational strength with an in-app concierge and a strict 2-hour resolution SLA.** Support in this industry is notoriously slow and treated as an afterthought; a guaranteed SLA can turn neglected users of competing apps into loyal advocates.

Reviewers also write long, detailed accounts when they experience billing fraud or fake profiles. This rich text feedback is a blueprint of what not to do, helping the client design a frictionless, transparent experience from day one.

Detailed recommendations

Profile verification and authenticity

- Introduce a strong profile verification process using appropriate identity and document checks.
- Provide visible verification indicators to help users identify verified profiles.
- Regularly monitor suspicious, duplicate and misleading profiles.
- Provide an easy option to report and block suspicious accounts.

Scam prevention and user safety

- Develop a dedicated safety and fraud-reporting system.
- Educate users about financial scams, suspicious requests and misleading information.
- Monitor unusual account activities and investigate reported complaints.
- Provide safety guidelines before users share personal or financial information.

Transparent subscription and payment system

- Clearly explain subscription plans, pricing and available features.
- Display payment terms, renewal conditions and cancellation policies.
- Provide transparent refund information.
- Send payment confirmations and subscription reminders to customers.

Privacy and data protection

- Give users control over their personal information and profile visibility.
- Protect sensitive profile details from unauthorised access.
- Provide secure communication options.
- Follow applicable data protection laws and maintain transparent privacy policies.

Improved customer support

- Establish a responsive customer support system.
- Provide easy access to complaint registration and tracking.
- Resolve payment, subscription and profile-related issues efficiently.
- Collect customer feedback regularly to improve service quality.

Customer experience and matchmaking quality

- Improve search filters and matching recommendations.
- Provide relevant and personalised profile suggestions.
- Make the application easy to navigate.
- Continuously evaluate customer satisfaction and service quality.

Business differentiation

- Build the brand around trust, safety and transparency.
- Offer clear and customer-friendly subscription options.
- Focus on genuine user experiences rather than only increasing registrations.
- Continuously improve services based on customer feedback and market research.

Overall Business Insights

The matrimony market provides opportunities for businesses that understand customer expectations and address the limitations of existing platforms. The major business opportunity is to create a platform where customers feel safe, respected and confident throughout their matchmaking journey. The proposed business should focus on:

Focus area	What it means
Trust	Building confidence through reliable profile verification.
Safety	Reducing the risk of fake profiles and fraudulent activities.
Transparency	Maintaining clear subscription and payment policies.
Privacy	Protecting customer information and personal details.
Service Quality	Providing responsive customer support.
Customer Satisfaction	Improving the overall matchmaking experience.

Final business vision

> To build a customer-centric matrimony platform that combines technology, transparency, profile authenticity and user safety to create a reliable and meaningful matchmaking experience.

Conclusion

The matrimony industry plays an important role in connecting individuals and families through digital platforms. With the growth of online matrimony applications, users have gained convenient access to potential life partners, personalised matchmaking services and communication features.

However, customer feedback highlights important areas that require attention, including profile authenticity, fake profile concerns, subscription transparency, payment-related difficulties, privacy protection and customer support.

The analysis of customer reviews provides an opportunity to understand user experiences, identify recurring complaints and recognise areas where existing platforms can improve. It also demonstrates the importance of building trust, maintaining transparency and providing reliable customer service.

For a new business entering the matrimony industry, success should not depend only on attracting users. It should also focus on creating a safe, trustworthy, transparent and customer-friendly matchmaking experience.

Overall, this project provides a foundation for understanding customer expectations, identifying market gaps and developing a business approach that prioritises customer satisfaction, safety and long-term trust.

References

The following sources support the industry research, customer safety, consumer protection and privacy-related analysis. Review platforms are the sources for customer feedback; official platforms and government websites are references for policies, privacy, safety and consumer protection.

Industry and platform references

- BharatMatrimony – Official Website
- BharatMatrimony – Privacy and Security
- Shaadi.com – Official Website
- Jeevansathi – Official Website
- BetterHalf – Official Website

Government and consumer-protection references

- Consumer Protection Act, 2019 – Government of India
- Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020
- Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal

Customer review data sources

- Google Play Store – BharatMatrimony
- Google Play Store – Shaadi.com
- Google Play Store – Jeevansathi
- Google Play Store – Telugu Matrimony
- Google Play Store – BetterHalf

Review collection period: September 2018 – October 2026.